The United States may be headed into an especially dark passage. In addition to the burdens imposed by an advanced welfare state, the United States has the singular burden of an aged empire. It is headed for bankruptcy—and perhaps worse—with a “military industrial complex” that needs to justify further wealth transfers to itself. In short, there are good times—and bad times—to be in certain places. This could be a bad time to have all your eggs in the U.S. basket.

To conclude this chapter: You need five hard structures in place. You need an owner of the family wealth, usually a trust. The owner needs an investment/bank account, usually in a place where you can trust the banks and the currency. You need a will and an estate plan. And you need a tax strategy that makes sense and connects these pieces with your family’s wealth and financial goals.

It is a big job to put these hard structures in place. Our advice: Start early. Take your time. “Go nuclear” only if you have to.

Notes

1. “Millionaires Go Missing,” *Wall Street Journal*, May 27, 2009.
2. Rich Rabkin, “Gold and Money in Extremis . . . One Man’s Story,” *The Gloom, Boom and Doom Report* (Marc Faber, ed.), November 2011.